



Learning curve: Last WPL, Richa Ghosh was inconsolable after being run out against Delhi Capitals on the final ball, with Royal Challengers Bengaluru needing two runs from the last delivery. But Richa says she has learnt a lot from that experience.

R.V. MOORTHY

that wherever I'm slotted. If I'm sent out to open, go one down, or come in at number 5, I aim to finish the game from there. So, I've never been particular about the batting order."

Richa's willingness to embrace pressure and her ability to step into this role address one of India's biggest challenges in big tournaments — maintaining momentum and closing out matches.

Several World Cup campaigns across both formats come to mind, including the heartbreaking ODI World Cup loss in England in 2017 and the collapse in the T20 World Cup final against Australia at the Melbourne Cricket Ground in

2020. As India continues to tackle issues like its inconsistent pace attack, middle-order stability, and fielding, Richa has been focusing on sharpening her technique.

Patience and perseverance

"I've tried to become a calmer version of myself," Richa shares. "When I was new to the team, there wasn't much pressure, but I was overly eager to make every opportunity count. I just wanted to hit every ball. Now, there's a lot of difference in how I construct an innings and focus on building partnerships."

Learning to value her wicket is

something Richa's father also pointed out, and over the past 12 months, it has become a conscious part of her game.

"International experiences, like her stints in the Women's Big Bash League (WBBL) and The Hundred, have been instrumental in her growth.

"I remember being very shy and nervous during my first WBBL stint. My English wasn't that good, and I wasn't sure how to communicate effectively with my teammates. I learnt to adapt, which not only helped me make friends but also understand how different leagues,



"I'll do that wherever I'm slotted. If I'm sent out to open, go one down, or come in at number 5, I aim to finish the game from there."